

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition

Goju-ryu or IKO Goju-ryu Version Only — Open Version for Kobudo (Weapon) Kata

Judge / Referee Playbook

For every judge and referee scoring this competition

1. Purpose

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition exists so that any Goju-ryu karateka, anywhere in the world, can step onto a real competitive stage without buying a plane ticket. A student in a small-town dojo and a student in a national training centre submit to the same panel, under the same rules, judged on the same criteria — distance and travel budget decide nothing.

The competition's job is to make that fair and trustworthy at scale: verified rank, verified recordings, a panel of judges who never sees who they are scoring, and a result that everyone — the participant, their sensei, and every other competitor — can check for themselves once winners are announced.

As a judge, you carry the part of that purpose that matters most: the score. Every participant's placing rests on your independent, honest read of their recording.

2. Identity

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition is a virtual, video-submission kata championship open to Goju-ryu and IKO Goju-ryu practitioners worldwide, plus an Open division for Kobudo (weapon) kata. It runs in three tiers — USD 10, USD 100 and USD 200 — so a first-time competitor and a seasoned Dan holder chasing a serious prize can both find their level.

It is not a video-upload contest that happens to involve karate. It is a karate competition that happens to be judged on video — the standards, the etiquette, and the seriousness of a real tournament apply throughout, from the certificate check at registration to the moment a judge scores a recording.

3. Beliefs & Values

- Honesty about your own rank comes first. Every participant confirms, in writing, that the belt rank they entered matches their uploaded certificate — a mismatch disqualifies the entry outright, no exceptions, because the whole scoring system depends on the right people being compared to the right people.

- Judging is blind and independent. A judge scores the recording in front of them, not the person — assignments, workload, and deadlines are managed so that no single judge's delay holds up a result: if a score is still missing two weeks after the deadline, the recording is reassigned; if it's still missing after that, the Chief Judge steps in before the winners are announced.
- One person, one honest attempt. Every participant gets three chances to delete and re-record a kata — enough to recover from a dropped phone or a bad take, not enough to endlessly audition for the best possible take against an opponent who only gets one submission.
- No refunds once you're in. Registration fees are not returned if a participant doesn't attend or changes their mind — the fee is what funds judges, the platform, and the prize pool for everyone who did show up.
- Respect the chain that got you here. A participant registers under their own School/Dojo and their own Sensei/Coach before registering themselves — the competition is built on the dojo relationships that trained each competitor, not on anonymous sign-ups.
- You score the recording in front of you, not the person. Assignments are handled so you're judging strangers' technique, not favours.
- A missing score is everyone's problem. That's why the reassignment safeguard exists — if you can't finish in your window, say so early rather than let a competitor's result stall.

4. Capabilities — What Your Registration Unlocks

As an approved Judge, here is exactly what you can do in the Kata Arena:

- Fee: USD 100 deposit per competition tier (returned with your judge reward).
- Kata Arena access: Every recording in the competition.
- Judge-by-judge scores: Every judge's individual score.
- Scoring: Yes — your assigned recordings.
- Judging area: Yes — assignments, workload, Full View.
- Admin panel: View only.
- Reward: Per-student judging reward.
- Telegram: All groups.
- Sign-in allowance: Unlimited sign-ins once approved.

5. Behaviors — What Is Expected Of You

- Register with your real karate rank and a verifiable certificate — Black Belt 1st Dan and above is the expected floor for judging.
- Score every recording assigned to you inside your window — roughly two weeks from the registration deadline.
- Judge the technique on screen against the stated criteria, not the participant's school, country, or anything outside the recording.
- Flag a technical problem with a recording (can't see the full kata, audio issue, wrong kata performed) rather than guessing or scoring it anyway.
- Keep your bank details accurate — your USD 100 deposit and judging reward are returned to the account you registered with.

6. Environment — Where This All Happens

Everything happens inside one web app, reachable from any phone, tablet, or computer with a camera and an internet connection — there is no separate software to install. Recording happens through the browser itself, using the device's own camera and microphone.

The competition year runs in stages, in this order: registration and payment → kata recording and submission → the registration deadline → a judging window (roughly four weeks, with reassignment safeguards built in) → the winners announcement → certificates and testimonials.

Money moves through Stripe (card or FPX) — the competition never sees or stores your card details. Everything else — your registration record, your recording, your score, your certificate — lives inside the Kata Arena, reachable any time you sign in during your competition tier's window.

Support and announcements run through Telegram, split by category, so a message reaches exactly the people it's meant for — your own group for day-to-day matters, plus the app's own Announcements page as the permanent written record.

Judging itself runs on a strict clock: your 2-week window starts at the registration deadline. Anything you haven't scored by then is reassigned to another judge, who gets a further week; if it's still unscored after that, the Chief Judge takes over before winners are announced.

7. Your Step-by-Step Journey

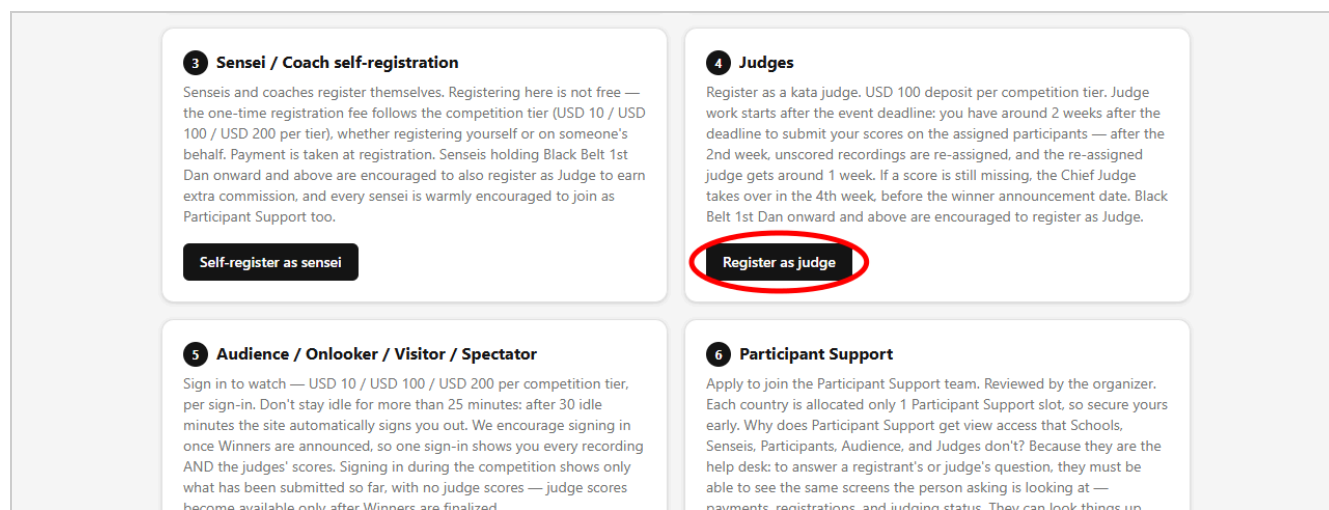
Follow these steps in order. Each screenshot shows exactly where to click — look for the red circle.

Step 0 — Before you start, have these ready

- Your IC / Passport.
- A clear photo or scan of your latest karate rank certificate.
- A recent passport-size photo of yourself.
- Your bank account details — for the return of your USD 100 deposit and your judging reward.

Step 1 — Register as a Judge

From the Home page, click Register, then Register as judge on the Registration hub.



The Registration hub — click Register as judge.

Choose your role (Chief Referee, Judge, All level Judge, etc.) and how many times you've judged a kata competition before.

School / organization *

IC / Passport *

Date of Birth: DD/MM/YYYY *

Gender *

Karate rank *

Role *

No. of times taking part in judging Kata competition *

Latest rank certificate *

Latest Passport Size Photo *

International certified Judge certificates (optional — unlimited uploads)

Select multiple files at once, or add this field again later — not required.

Choose your judging role.

Upload your latest rank certificate, then your passport-size photo — both are required.

DD/MM/YYYY

Gender *

Karate rank *

Role *

No. of times taking part in judging Kata competition *

Latest rank certificate *

Latest Passport Size Photo *

International certified Judge certificates (optional — unlimited uploads)

Email *

Mobile / WhatsApp *

Upload your latest rank certificate.

IC / Passport *	Date of Birth: DD/MM/YYYY *
Gender *	Karate rank *
Select gender	e.g. Godan
Role *	No. of times taking part in judging Kata competition *
Select role	e.g. 5 (0 if none)
Latest rank certificate *	Latest Passport Size Photo *
Choose file Take picture	Choose file Take picture
No file selected yet. Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, HEIC, PDF. Max 10 MB.	No photo Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, HEIC, WEBP. Max 5 MB.
International certified Judge certificates (optional — unlimited uploads)	
Choose Files No file chosen	
Select multiple files at once, or add this field again later — not required.	
Email *	Mobile / WhatsApp *

Upload a recent passport-size photo of yourself.

Pick which competition tier(s) you're available to judge — Tier 1 is required, up to 3.

City / Town *	Postcode *	
	e.g. 50000	
Home country *		
Malaysia		
Kata Competition Tier(s) you'll judge (Tier 1 required, up to 3)		
Tier 1 *	Tier 2	Tier 3
— None —	— None —	— None —
Tier 1 is required — pick every tier you're available to judge, up to 3. The USD 100 deposit below already covers all 3 tiers regardless of what you pick here; this is only so the organizer can schedule you correctly.		
Bank details — for return of the USD 100 deposit & judge reward *		
Note: participants outside Malaysia — please provide your IBAN, SWIFT code, BIC, BBAN, or ACH number. If you don't know your IBAN, please call your bank to check. This ensures smooth processing with no delay in receiving any reward or commission.		
Bank name *	International Bank Account No. (IBAN) *	

Choose the tier(s) you'll judge.

Enter your bank details — this is where your USD 100 deposit and judging reward are returned.

Malaysia

Kata Competition Tier(s) you'll judge (Tier 1 required, up to 3)

Tier 1 * Tier 2 Tier 3

— None — — None — — None —

Tier 1 is required — pick every tier you're available to judge, up to 3. The USD 100 deposit below already covers all 3 tiers regardless of what you pick here; this is only so the organizer can schedule you correctly.

Bank details — for return of the USD 100 deposit & judge reward *

Note: participants outside Malaysia — please provide your IBAN, SWIFT code, the bank, or A/C number. If you don't know your IBAN, please call your bank to check. This ensures smooth processing with no delay in receiving any reward or commission.

Bank name * International Bank Account No. (IBAN) *

Account holder name *

☐ I have double-checked that the IBAN / account number above is correct.

Bank details for your deposit and reward.

Step 2 — Pay the USD 100 deposit

Submit the form and complete payment via Stripe (card or FPX). This is a deposit, not a fee — it's returned to you together with your judging reward once your judging duties are complete.

Invitation code (optional)

Referral / Where did you hear about this competition? (optional)

e.g. friend's name, social media name, relative name, any event name, or any channel name or competition support

Please don't name your own Dojo's PIC or Sensei here — if a friend told you about this competition, give their name instead.

Submit referee / judge registration

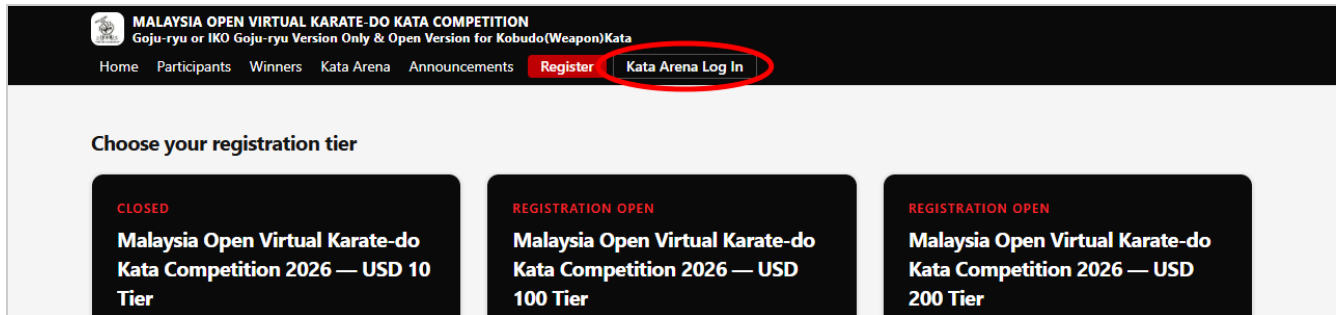
Submit your judge registration.

Step 3 — Wait for approval

The organizer reviews every judge application. You'll get an email and Telegram notice the moment your status changes to Approved — there's nothing to do on your end while you wait.

Step 4 — Sign in to the Kata Arena

Click Kata Arena Log In from anywhere on the site, then sign in with the account you registered with.



Kata Arena Log In — the sign-in point for every role, on every page.

The image shows the "Kata Arena Log In" sign-in form. At the top, there are two buttons: "Sign in" (red) and "Create account" (white). Below these is a yellow "Note" box containing text about account security and sign-in limits for Audience/Spectator and Participants. The form itself has a white background and contains the following elements: an "Email *" field with a red circle around the label, a "Password *" field with a red circle around the label and a toggle icon, a "Forgot password?" link, a checkbox for "I am not a robot or AI *", and a red "Sign in" button at the bottom.

My Account — sign in here.

Step 5 — Review your assigned recordings

Once approved and signed in, My Account shows a Judge section listing every recording assigned to you — participant, kata, and category, with a running count of how many you've scored.

 *This screen needs you signed in to capture — added as soon as a Kata Arena login is available.*

Step 6 — Score each recording

Open a recording, watch the full kata, and submit your score against the competition's scoring criteria (Score Sheet 1 and 2). You can't see any other judge's score for the same recording — every score is independent.

 *This screen needs you signed in to capture — added as soon as a Kata Arena login is available.*

Step 7 — Finish inside your window

You have roughly two weeks from the registration deadline. Anything you haven't scored by then is automatically reassigned — so if something's blocking you (a broken recording, an unclear category), flag it to the organizer early rather than let the deadline pass.

Step 8 — After judging closes

Once every recording you were assigned has a submitted score, there's nothing further required from you. Your deposit and judging reward are transferred to the bank account you registered with.

Quick Reference

- USD 100 deposit — returned with your judging reward, not kept as a fee.
- Scoring window: ~2 weeks from the registration deadline.
- Unscoed recordings are reassigned after 2 weeks; the Chief Judge takes over after a further week if still unscoed.
- You score independently — no visibility into other judges' scores for the same recording.
- Sign in any time via Kata Arena Log In, top-right of every page.

Specially for all Goju-ryu Karateka to compete globally without leaving their beloved Country.